

To download a file if it is modified before/after a given time, use the `-z` option, as follows:

```
$ curl -z 28-Nov-11 http://www.my.com/aa.html
```

To download `yy.html` from the server that's been modified after November 28, use the following command:

```
$ curl -z -28-Nov-11 http://www.my.com/bb.html
```

Sometimes a website may ask for your user name and password when you wish to view the contents, at which point, pass the user name and password in the command as shown below:

```
$ curl -u username:password URL
```

This can be very useful when downloading files from password protected FTP sites.

To ignore the SSL certificate, use the `-k` option with the following command:

```
$ curl -k https://www.abc.com
```

There are many other uses for Curl. You can check out the man pages for more details.

—Ajay Trivedi, ajay.trivedi@minjar.com



Analysing your Wi-Fi signal strength on Ubuntu

The Wi-Fi signal strength can vary from room to room, so it's good to know which is the best spot in the house or office to work from. Here is a simple script to find out the signal strength in Ubuntu.

Create a text file called `signalstr.sh` and enter the following script:

```
#!/bin/bash
echo "Please enter the wireless interface you wish to use"
read wifiinterface
echo "Please enter the routers ip address(or any system you wish to ping)"
read pingaddress

count=0
echo "Interface: $wifiinterface    Ping Address: $pingaddress"
>> ~/wifianalyse.log
echo "    Time    Count    Output Ping"
echo "    Time    Count    Output Ping" >> ~/wifianalyse.log
while [ 1 -eq 1 ]
do
    sleep 1
    count=$((count + 1))
    countf=$(printf "%05s" $count)
```

```
wifioutput=$(iwconfig $wifiinterface | grep -i --color quality)
pingoutput=$(ping -c 1 $pingaddress | grep -E -o -m 1
'time.(0,10)' & )
curtime=$(date +%d/%m/%Y %H:%M:%S)
echo [ $curtime ] "|" " $countf" "|" " $wifioutput "|" "
$pingoutput
echo [ $curtime ] "|" " $countf" "|" " $wifioutput "|" "
$pingoutput >> ~/wifianalyse.log
done
```

Save the text file and then run the script using the following command:

```
#sh signalstr.sh
```

After running this script, you're instantly asked to enter the wireless interface name you wish to test, along with the IP address of your router to ping. This information is crucial to the running of the script, so make sure you enter the correct information. As soon as you enter the two details, it will start showing the signal level for you.

—Harish Tiwari, harishtiwary46@gmail.com



Disabling a guest account

Guest accounts on a computer can be useful, but some people (myself included) see them as a waste of space. To disable the guest account, run the command `sudo`.

Open the terminal and install as follows:

```
$sudo apt install gksu
```

Now run the following command:

```
$gksudo gedit /etc/lightdm/lightdm.conf.d/50-no-guest.conf
```

Add the following command and exit:

```
[SeatDefaults]
allow-guest=false
```

This is a simple configuration file modification, which the system reads during each boot up.

—Harish Tiwari, harishtiwary46@gmail.com



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